



Liverpool after playing out a goalless draw, but enjoyed a slice of good fortune as Manchester City failed to capitalise after finishing 1-1 against Brighton and Hove Albion.

It wasn't a happy gameweek for the other North London club, Tottenham Hotspur, with Thomas Frank's men going down 2-3 against Bournemouth. Antoine Semenyo finished his Cherries stint in style, scoring a 90+5-minute winner before making his big-money move to Manchester City.

After gameweek 21, Arsenal (49) enjoys a six-point lead at the top, with Man City (43) in second. Aston Villa (43) and Liverpool (35) are third and fourth. Man United (32) is seventh, with Chelsea (31) in eighth. Tottenham lies 14th with 27 points.

La Liga

When Barcelona travelled to the RCDE Stadium to take on Espanyol, there was no player under more pressure than Joan Garcia. The 24-year-old goalkeeper, whose heroics once helped Espanyol gain promotion to the top tier, was booed

and targeted by fans from the warm-up for switching to their Catalan rivals in the summer.

However, once the whistle blew for kick-off, it was Garcia's time to remind the spectators of his quality as he made as many as six crucial saves, each better than the other, walking away with the Player of the Match award.

While he held the fort at one end, Barcelona managed to eke out a 2-0 win thanks to late goals from Dani Olmo and Robert Lewandowski, ensuring it maintains top spot in the league.

Meanwhile, title challenger Real Madrid kept pace with a 5-1 thrashing of Real Betis. Twenty-one-year-old Gonzalo Garcia made full use of his opportunity to start in the absence of Kylian Mbappe by bagging a hat-trick, while Raul Asencio and Fran Garcia also got on the scoresheet to keep Barcelona's advantage over Real to just four points.

Atletico Madrid failed to make progress in its bid to challenge for the title after it was held to a 1-1

Gentle reminder: Former Espanyol man Joan Garcia produced a composed and courageous display against his old club, keeping a clean sheet as Barcelona secured a 2-0 victory. AP

draw by Real Sociedad, allowing Villarreal, which won against Alaves, to move into third place.

Bundesliga

Defending champion Bayern Munich returned from the winter break and looked sharper than ever as it demolished VfL Wolfsburg 8-1 to extend its lead at the top. Michael Olise scored a brace while Wolfsburg scored two own goals, making it a third consecutive league game in which it has put the ball into its own net, also setting an unwanted Bundesliga record.

Bayern's closest challenger, Borussia Dortmund, dropped more points after playing out a 3-3 draw against Eintracht Frankfurt. With the scoreline 2-2 at the 90-minute mark, Eintracht thought it had secured a